

A SIMPLE VISUAL GUIDE

# iCloud vs iPhone Storage

Why your phone says it's "out of storage" — and how the two are completely different.

PHOTO RESCUE by Geiger



iPhone



iCloud

# They Are NOT the Same Thing

Two separate places your stuff can live. Either one can fill up on its own.



## iPhone Storage

Think of it as YOUR HOUSE

*The space physically inside your phone.*

- Photos & videos
- Apps
- Messages
- Downloads

**Full? Can't take photos, apps slow down, updates fail.**



## iCloud Storage

Think of it as a STORAGE LOCKER

*Apple's online cloud storage — separate from your phone.*

- Device backups
- Synced photos
- Documents
- Files across devices

**Full? Backups stop, photos stop syncing, Apple asks you to upgrade.**

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# The Most Common Confusion

Your iPhone can have plenty of room WHILE your iCloud is completely full.



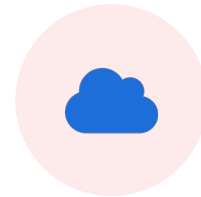
iPhone Storage

**60 GB**

**FREE**



Plenty of room



iCloud Storage

**0 GB**

**FREE**

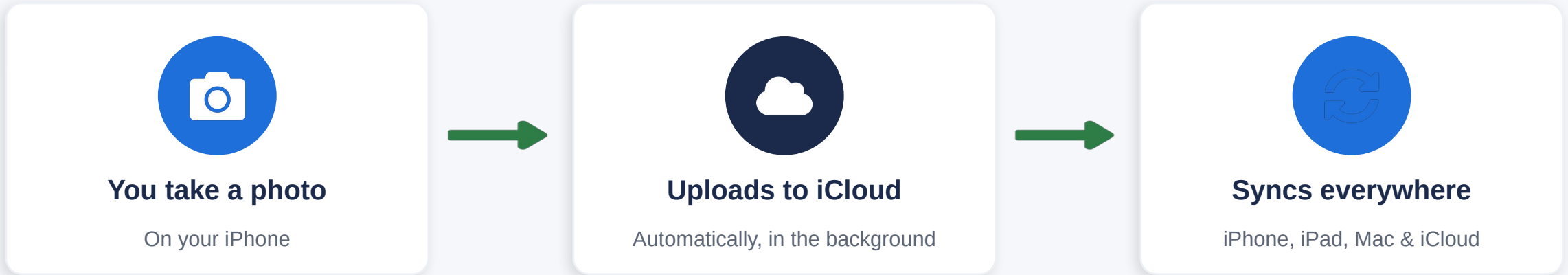


Storage full

Same person. Same day. Two totally separate storage spaces.

# Why iCloud Keeps Filling Up

When iCloud Photos is ON, every new photo uploads automatically — so it keeps growing over time.



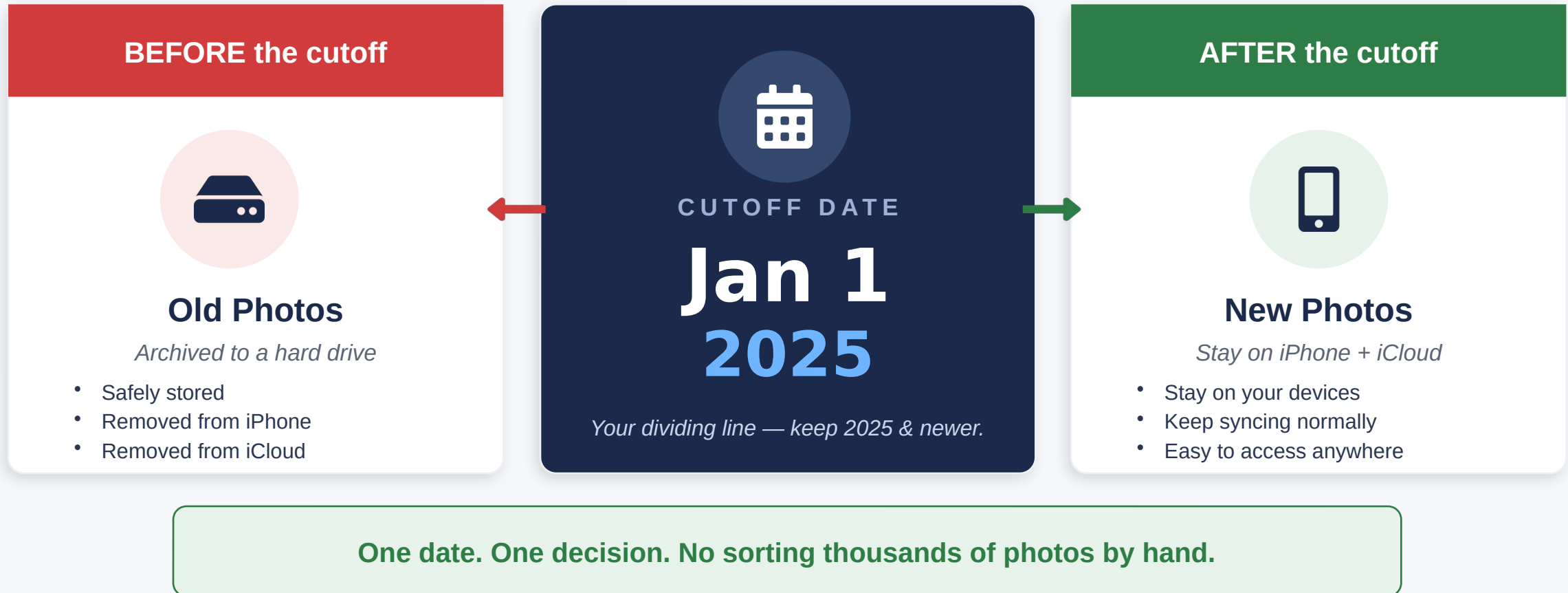
## The Bathtub Analogy

**You drain the tub** (delete old photos), but the **faucet is still running** (iCloud Photos is ON). New photos and videos keep flowing in — so it fills right back up.

*iCloud isn't refilling itself — new photos are continuously syncing into it.*

# The Smart Fix: A Photo Cutoff Date

Pick one date. Everything BEFORE it gets archived to a hard drive. Everything AFTER it stays on your phone.



# How to Remove Photos Safely

Free up space without losing a single memory. Follow these five steps in order.



**BACK UP FIRST.** When iCloud Photos is ON, deleting a photo from iCloud also deletes it from your iPhone and every synced device. Never delete anything until it is safely copied and verified.

1



## Copy to a Drive

Move photos & videos to a computer or external hard drive.

2



## Verify Them

Open the files and confirm they are all there and not corrupt.

3



## Turn Off Sync

Turn off iCloud Photos (if desired) so nothing re-uploads.

4



## Delete Old Photos

Remove the photos you no longer need from iCloud & iPhone.

5



## Empty 'Recently Deleted'

Clear that album to actually reclaim the storage space.

iCloud Photos is a sync service, not a backup — that's why Step 1 matters most.

# Do You Really Need Lots of iCloud?

The more Apple devices you sync, the more valuable iCloud becomes. It's the glue that keeps them in sync.

## If you ONLY use an iPhone



### One device to keep backed up

- Mainly need iCloud for a phone backup
- A smaller (or free) plan may be enough
- Great fit for archiving photos to a drive

## If you use iPhone + MacBook + iPad



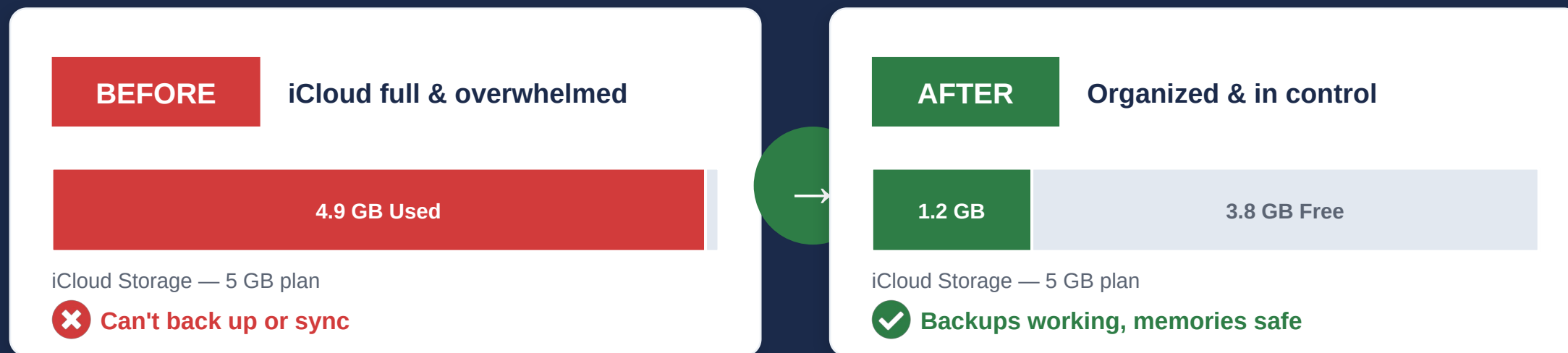
### iCloud keeps them all in sync

- Take a photo once — it appears everywhere
- Photos, files, contacts & notes stay matched
- A larger plan is usually worth it here

**The rule of thumb:** one device = less cloud needed. Many devices = iCloud is the glue worth paying for.

# How Photo Rescue Helps

We safely move your memories off your phone — freeing space without losing a thing.



Preserve  
your memories



Archive photos  
safely



Avoid paying for  
extra storage



Free up space  
on your iPhone



# The Bottom Line



## iPhone Storage

The space INSIDE your phone.



## iCloud Storage

Apple's ONLINE storage.

**They are separate — either one can become full on its own.**

*Ready to free up space and protect your memories?*



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**PHOTO RESCUE** by Geiger